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23. On the Pakistani elite views of nuclear weapons, see Kamal Matinuddin, *The Nuclearization of South Asia* (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2002).
24. On the likely human and economic costs of a nuclear exchange in South Asia, see Tom Shanker, “12 Million Could Die at Once in an India-Pakistan Nuclear War,” *New York Times*, May 27, 2002; Bill Nichols, “Nuclear Clash Would Batter World Financial Markets,” *USA Today*, June 4, 2002.
25. On the nuclear taboo, see Nina Tannenwald, *The Nuclear Taboo: The United States and the Non-use of Nuclear Weapons since 1945* (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 2007).
26. See Barry R. Posen, *Inadvertent Escalation* (Ithaca, N.Y.: Cornell University Press, 1991).

4. SOUTH ASIA’S NUCLEAR PAST

1. John Lewis Gaddis, *The Long Peace: Inquiries into the History of the Cold Wa*r (New York: Oxford University Press, 1989).
2. Ashley J. Tellis, *India’s Emerging Nuclear Posture* (Santa Monica, Calif.: Rand, 2001), 196–97.
3. As early as 1966, reacting to Pakistan’s long-standing conventional military weakness vis-à-vis India, Pakistani prime minister Zulfikar Ali Bhutto famously promised that Pakistanis would “eat grass” if necessary to ensure their achievement of a nuclear weapons capability. However, the Bangladesh war and the Indian PNE created even stronger incentives for Pakistan to develop nuclear weapons. See Samina Ahmed, “Pakistan’s Nuclear Weapons Program: Turning Points and Nuclear Choices,” *International Security*, 32, no. 4 (Spring 1999): 183.
4. See S. Paul Kapur, *Dangerous Deterrent: Nuclear Weapons Proliferation and Conflict in South Asia* (Stanford, Calif.: Stanford University Press, 2007); Devin T. Hagerty, *The Consequences of Nuclear Proliferation: Lessons from South Asia* (Cambridge, Mass.: MIT Press, 1998).
5. A. G. Noorani, “India’s Quest for a Nuclear Guarantee,” *Asian Survey* 7, no. 7 (July 1967): 490–502.
6. Ashok Kapur, *India’s Nuclear Option: Atomic Diplomacy and Decision-Making* (New York: Praeger, 1976).
7. Šumit Ganguly, “Why India Joined the Nuclear Club,” *Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists* 39, no. 4 (April 1983): 30–33.
8. Raj Chengappa, *Weapons of Peace: The Secret Story of India’s Quest to be a Nuclear Power* (New Delhi: Harper Collins, 2000).
9. Adrian Levy and Catherine Scott-Clark, *Deception: Pakistan, the United States, and the Global Nuclear Weapons Conspiracy* (New Delhi: Penguin Books, 2007).
10. Mark Tully and Satish Jacob, *Amritsar: Mrs. Gandhi’s Last Battle* (London: Jonathan Cape, 1985).
11. Vivek Chadha, *Low-Intensity Conflicts in India: An Analysis* (New Delhi: Sage, 2005).
12. This was India’s largest military exercise to date and comparable in size to those of the Warsaw Pact or the North Atlantic Treaty Organization in scope and dimensions. See